



WHEAT



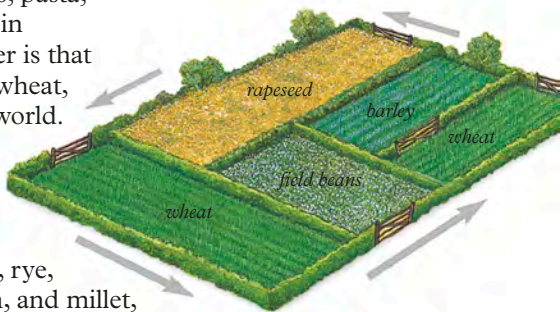
What have breakfast cereals, breads, cakes, pastries, pasta, and couscous all got in common? The answer is that they are made out of wheat, the most important crop in the world. Wheat is so important that it is known as a staple food. It is a main everyday source of food for more than 35 percent of the world's people. Like barley, oats, rye, corn, rice, sorghum, and millet, wheat is a cereal. Cereals are grasses and we eat their seeds.

This is the unloading spout. It is used to empty threshed grain from the harvester.

In the harvester, the grain is shaken off the stalks. The stalks fall to the ground in the back.

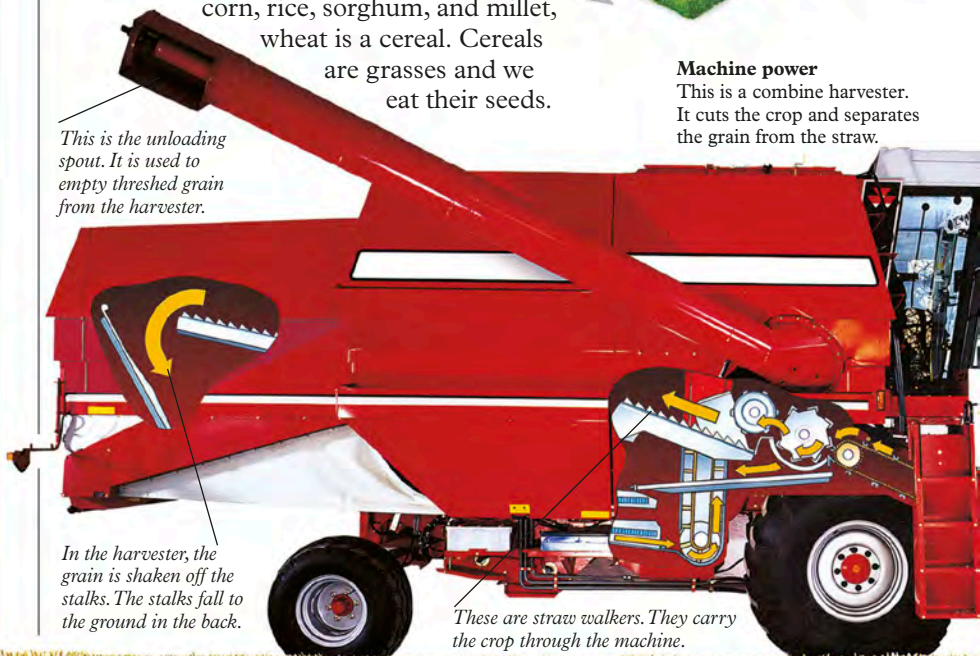
Crop rotation

If the same crop is grown on the same land year after year, the soil may lose its fertility and pests and diseases build up. The farmer can prevent this by changing the crops grown each year. In the first year, rapeseed may be grown, then wheat, field beans, wheat, and barley.



Machine power

This is a combine harvester. It cuts the crop and separates the grain from the straw.



These are straw walkers. They carry the crop through the machine.